

Proposal & Team Contract

BUAD-304 | Organizational Behavior and Leadership

Instructor: Christine El Haddad

Term: Fall 2026

Assignment Summary

Grade weight:	3%
Start date:	2026-08-31
Due date:	2026-09-28
Group project:	Yes

Overview (Course Evaluation)

Proposal & Team Contract 3%

Course Schedule (due dates)

- Due: 2026-09-28 | 10.1-10.4 Team project proposal & team 9/28 tion & Listen to: NPR - Why Corporate Jargon contract due Conflict Never Seems To Go Away (3-min. audio) Assessment(s): • Self-Assessment 9.01 Assessing My

Course Schedule (dated sessions)

- 2026-08-26 | 8/26 Attitudes & ARES Reading: Park, N. & Peterson, C. Character Strengths Ethics (2009) Character Strengths: Research and assessment in class. Practice Other: Watch the USC-CT and Case Analysis videos at this link. M Individual Textbook Re
- 2026-08-31 | 8/31 Differences Assessments: this week so you can start • Self-Assessment 3.01 What is my Big thinking about your topics and Five personality profile? on Connect get started on your proposals. • Self-Assessment 3.04: What Is Your Level of
- 2026-09-23 | 9/23 Exercise: 12 Angry Men M Communica- Textbook Reading: Ch. 9 & 10.1-10.4 Team project proposal & team
- 2026-09-28 | 9/28 tion & Listen to: NPR - Why Corporate Jargon contract due Conflict Never Seems To Go Away (3-min. audio) Assessment(s): • Self-Assessment 9.01 Assessing My Communication Competence on Connect • Self-Assessment 10.5 Preferred Conflict H

Related Mentions

- Team Project
- You will work with your team throughout the semester to prepare for and complete the Team Project. The

- goals of the team project are (1) to enrich your understanding of organizations and leadership; (2) to provide
- you with an opportunity to apply what you have learned in the course; (3) to assess your ability to analyze
- an organization or organizations and come to insightful conclusions and (4) to help you develop critical
- interpersonal and teamwork skills.
- Your team will have a choice of conducting either:
- 1. A fieldwork study with a local organization such as a student organization, business unit on campus, or
- other local company. Your team will investigate and analyze some aspect of this organization that
- connects with themes in the course such as the organization's culture, rewards system or the structure
- and functioning of groups within the organization. You will identify best practices and make
- recommendations based on your study.
- 4
- 2. An issue analysis of an issue/topic connected to the themes in the course and of importance to multiple
- organizations; this issue may be inspired by something in the headlines of the business press or
- something in your own experience. You will need to examine the nature of this issue and analyze in
- detail how different companies have addressed and/or experienced the issue. You will identify best
- practices and make recommendations based on your study using archival sources (i.e. library research).
- Your "deliverable" for this project has five components:
- 1. Project proposal with team contract
- 2. Detailed outline of paper
- 3. Project paper
- 4. In-class presentation followed by Q&A
- 5. Self & peer evaluation feedback (online assessment explained in class).
- Submitted assignments should use 12-point, Times New Roman font, double-spaced, with 1-inch
- margins
- on all sides.
- Feedback helps you learn and improve your performance as well as the quality of your output as a team.
- As part of the team project, you will practice and develop skills in providing and receiving effective
- feedback through in-class exercises and a more formal peer evaluation survey. The criteria for the peer
- evaluation will be discussed in class and posted to Brightspace.
- The final grade for this project is based on four components: the project proposal, the project paper, the

- presentation, and the self & peer evaluation. The team project will be evaluated based on the quality of the
- analysis, the appropriate use of course concepts, principles and frameworks, the logic and substantiation of
- conclusions, the clarity, organization and style of the writing and the quality of your class presentation. The
- detailed outline of the paper is not graded but you will receive feedback to help improve the final paper.
- Further instructions and grading rubrics will be posted to Brightspace.
- Grades for individual student contributions to the team project are assigned by your Professor, based on
- my observations of the team's working dynamics, my assessment of the team project quality, and thoughtful
- consideration of the information provided through your peer evaluations.
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Full Syllabus Extract

Team Project You will work with your team throughout the semester to prepare for and complete the Team Project. The goals of the team project are (1) to enrich your understanding of organizations and leadership; (2) to provide you with an opportunity to apply what you have learned in the course; (3) to assess your ability to analyze an organization or organizations and come to insightful conclusions and (4) to help you develop critical interpersonal and teamwork skills. Your team will have a choice of conducting either: 1. A fieldwork study with a local organization such as a student organization, business unit on campus, or other local company. Your team will investigate and analyze some aspect of this organization that connects with themes in the course such as the organization's culture, rewards system or the structure and functioning of groups within the organization. You will identify best practices and make recommendations based on your study. 4

2. An issue analysis of an issue/topic connected to the themes in the course and of importance to multiple organizations; this issue may be inspired by something in the headlines of the business press or something in your own experience.

You will need to examine the nature of this issue and analyze in detail how different companies have addressed and/or experienced the issue. You will identify best practices and make recommendations based on your study using archival sources (i.e. library research). Your "deliverable" for this project has five components: 1. Project proposal with team contract 2. Detailed outline of paper 3. Project paper 4. In-class presentation followed by Q&A 5. Self & peer evaluation feedback (online assessment explained in class). Submitted assignments should use 12-point, Times New Roman font, double-spaced, with 1-inch margins on all sides. Feedback helps you learn and improve your performance as well as the quality of your output as a team. As part of the team project, you will practice and develop skills in providing and receiving effective feedback through in-class exercises and a more formal peer evaluation survey. The criteria for the peer evaluation will be discussed in class and posted to Brightspace. The final grade for this project is based on four components: the project proposal, the project paper, the presentation, and the self & peer evaluation. The team project will be evaluated based on the quality of the analysis, the appropriate use of course concepts, principles and frameworks, the logic and substantiation of conclusions, the clarity, organization and style of the writing and the quality of your class presentation. The detailed outline of the paper is not graded but you will receive feedback to help improve the final paper. Further instructions and grading rubrics will be posted to Brightspace. Grades for individual student contributions to the team project are assigned by your Professor, based on my observations of the team's working dynamics, my assessment of the team project quality, and thoughtful consideration of the information provided through your peer evaluations.

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